

# Nisarg Patel

Ph.D. candidate

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## Education

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| <b>PhD</b>                       | <b>University of Southern California</b> , Comparative Studies in Literature and Culture<br>• Comparative Media and Culture                 | California, USA<br>2021 – present |
| <b>Master of Arts</b>            | <b>University of Toronto</b> , Comparative Literature<br>• GPA 3.97/4.00                                                                    | Ontario, Canada<br>2019 – 2020    |
| <b>Bachelor of Arts (Honors)</b> | <b>University of Toronto</b> , English Literature (major), Cinema Studies (minor), Literary Theory and Criticism (minor)<br>• GPA 3.74/4.00 | Ontario, Canada<br>2016 – 2019    |
| <b>Bachelor of Arts</b>          | <b>Indira Gandhi Open University</b> , Philosophy<br>• First Class                                                                          | India<br>2013 – 2016              |
| <b>Bachelor of Engineering</b>   | <b>Gujarat Technological University</b> , Production Engineering<br>• GPA 8.14/10.00                                                        | Gujarat, India<br>2012 – 2013     |

## Awards

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| <b>Silver Medal, Outstanding Academic Achievement</b><br>St. Michael's College, University of Toronto              | 2019      |
| <b>Dr. Michael Lutsky Undergraduate Award in Humanities</b><br>Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto | 2018-2019 |
| <b>Dean's List of Scholars</b><br>University of Toronto                                                            | 2016-2019 |
| <b>Research Award for Outstanding Engineering Project</b><br>Birla Vishwakarma Mahavidyalaya                       | 2016      |

## Conference Presentations

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**Writing After Amnesia: The Narratives of History between G.N. Devy and Qurratulain Hyder:** ACLA Annual Conference, 2025-2026; Seminar Organizer: Uses and Abuses of History in Literary Narratives

**To See a World in a Frame of an Image: Stereoscopes and Colonial Life-Worlds [Lebenswelt] of British India:** Annual Conference on South Asia, U. Wisconsin-Madison, 2025-2026

**Between Two Deaths: The Work of Silence in the Thought of Ranajit Guha and Gayatri Spivak:** CSLC Annual Graduate Student Symposium, USC, 2025-2026

**Visions of Pasts, Fictions of History:** Winter Workshop on Photography, Universität Tübingen, 2024-2025

**Witnessing Empire: Stereoscopes and the 1857 Mutiny in British India:** Media Fields Journal Biennial IX Conference, 2024-2025

**Ancient Myths, Modern Markets:** Summer Workshop on South Asian Literature, Universität Tübingen, 2022-2023

**Nationalist Ideologies in the Time of Transnational Cinema:** CARGC Symposium, University of Pennsylvania, 2022-2023

**हमारे अपनो को जगाना है: Bollywood's Histories in the Time of Hindu Nationalism:** SAGSC XX, University of Chicago, 2022-2023

**After-Images of Pre-Colonial India:** NYU Cinema Studies Conference, NYU, 2022-2023

**मेरे पास माँ है: Material and Sentimental Excess in Visual Cultures of Post-Colonial India:** First Forum, USC, 2021-2022

**Hello, Hello, Ji: Networks of Sociality and Commodity in Post-Colonial India:** Annual Conference on South Asia, U. Wisconsin-Madison, 2021-2022

**Expert Yogis, Impotent Men, Depressed Wives: Social Life of Sexual Tonics in Late Colonial India:** CSLC Graduate Symposium, USC, 2021-2022

**Making Space, Indulging Fantasies: Studio Photo in Colonial and Post-Colonial India:** Annual South Asian Studies Conference, University of Chicago, 2021-2022

**Glimpse of an Old Home: On Hermeneutics of Colonial-gaze and the Gaze of Colonial-Hermeneutics:** Research-Fellow Presentation, Jackman Humanities Institute, UofT

## Fellowships

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**Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant:** USC, 2026 Summer

**Graduate Scholar, Society of Fellows in Humanities:** Levan Institute of Humanities, USC, 2025-2026

**Teresa Wilson Endowed Fellowship:** USC, 2025-2026

**VSGC Summer Research Fellowship:** VSRI, USC, 2025 Summer

**Salz Pollak Pollak Research Fellowship:** USC, 2024-2025

**VSGC Summer Research Fellowship:** VSRI, USC, 2024 Summer

**CSLC Summer Research Fellowship,:** CSLC, USC, 2024 Summer

**NEH/VSRI Images out of Time Graduate Fellow:** VSRI, USC, 2023-2024

**USC-LACMA Summer Research Fellowship,:** VSRI and CSLC, USC, 2023 Summer

**PhD Academy Scholarship and Research Fund,:** Dornsife PhD Academy, USC, 2022-2026

**GSG Professional Development Fund,:** Graduate Student Government, USC, 2022-2026

**Graduate Research Fellowship,:** East Asian Studies, University of Toronto, 2020

**Center for Comparative Literature Graduate Program Award,:** University of Toronto, 2019-2020

**Writers-in-Residence Fellowship for Creative Writing,:** Massey College, University of Toronto, 2019-2020

**Undergraduate Research Fellowship,:** Jackman Humanities Institute, University of Toronto, 2018-2019

## Publications

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### **Zur Elektrodynamik bewegter Körper**

It concerned an interpretation of the Michelson–Morley experiment and the properties of light and time. Special relativity incorporates the principle that the speed of light is the same for all inertial observers regardless of the state of motion of the source.

Albert Einstein

[en.wikisource.org/wiki/Translation:On\\_the\\_Electrodynamics\\_of\\_Moving\\_Bodies](https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Translation:On_the_Electrodynamics_of_Moving_Bodies)

### **Über einen die Erzeugung und Verwandlung des Lichtes betreffenden heuristischen Gesichtspunkt**

In the second paper, he applied the quantum theory to light to explain the photoelectric effect. In particular, he used the idea of light quanta (photons) to explain experimental results, but stressed the importance of the experimental results. The importance of his work on the photoelectric effect earned him the Nobel Prize in Physics in 1921.

Albert Einstein

[de.wikisource.org/wiki/%C3%9Cber\\_einen\\_die\\_Erzeugung\\_und\\_Verwandlung\\_des\\_Lichtes\\_betreffenden\\_heuristischen\\_Gesichtspunkt](https://de.wikisource.org/wiki/%C3%9Cber_einen_die_Erzeugung_und_Verwandlung_des_Lichtes_betreffenden_heuristischen_Gesichtspunkt)

### **Die Grundlage der allgemeinen Relativitätstheorie**

The publication of the theory of general relativity made him internationally famous. He was professor of physics at the universities of Zurich (1909–1911) and Prague (1911–1912), before he returned to ETH Zurich (1912–1914).

Albert Einstein

[de.wikisource.org/wiki/Die\\_Grundlage\\_der\\_allgemeinen\\_Relativit%C3%A4tstheorie](https://de.wikisource.org/wiki/Die_Grundlage_der_allgemeinen_Relativit%C3%A4tstheorie)

## Teaching Experience

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**On Location: The Place of Literature in Global Culture:** 2023-2024, Teaching Assistant

**Introduction to Sociology:** 2023-2024, Teaching Assistant

**On Location: The Place of Literature in Global Culture:** 2022-2023, Teaching Assistant

**Cultures of Latin America:** 2022-2023, Teaching Assistant

## Research Experience

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**Graduate Research Assistant:** Visual Studies Research Institute (USC), 2026-2027

**Graduate Summer Research Assistant:** Prof. Kimia Shahi (USC), 2024

**History of Photography Summer Research:** Britt Salvesen (LACMA), 2023

**Graduate Summer Research Assistant:** Prof. Atsuko Sakaki (University of Toronto), 2020

**Editorial Assistant:** Prof. Martin Revermann (University of Toronto), 2020

**Graduate Research Assistant:** Prof. Sara Saljoughi (University of Toronto), 2019-2020

## Languages

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### **Hindi**

Native speaker

### **Gujarati**

Native speaker

### **English**

Full Proficiency

### **French**

Intermediate Proficiency

**Interests** \_\_\_\_\_

Fields

**Certificates** \_\_\_\_\_

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|----------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Certificate in Communication, Leadership, and Management | 2025 |
| Visual Studies Graduate Certificate                      | 2024 |
| Center for Excellence in Teaching Certificate            | 2024 |
| Digital Media and Culture Graduate Certificate           | 2023 |

**Projects** \_\_\_\_\_

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| <b>Theory Today</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2024 – present |
| <p>‘Theory Today’ working group aims primarily to read and discuss the diverse range of trends within contemporary theory. From Psychoanalysis to contemporary interventions within Marxism, Postcolonial thought, Media Theory, and Gender and Sexuality studies, this group engages with recently published monographs and essays from various fields and backgrounds that are actively shaping contemporary theoretical discourse.</p> |                |

**References** \_\_\_\_\_

- Professor Neetu Khanna, University of Southern California
- Professor Priya Jaikumar, University of Southern California
- Professor Panivong Norindr, University of Southern California
- Professor Vanessa Schwartz, University of Southern California
- Professor Ronald Mendoza-de Jesús, Emory University